18.10 Tamil Information Interchange Coding Systems

TSCII (Tamil Script Code for Information Interchange)

Computers handle data and information as binary system. Every data should be converted into binary when it is fed into a computer system. You have learnt about all these things in the first unit of this text book. Computers use ASCII encoding system to handle data and information. The ASCII encoding system is applicable only for handling English language. Therefore, TSCII (Tamil Script Code for Information Interchange) is the first coding system to handle our Tamil language in an analysis of an encoding scheme that is easily handled in electronic devices, including non-English computers. This encoding scheme was registered in IANA (Internet Assigned Numbers Authority) a unit of ICANN.

ISCII (Indian Script Code for Information Interchange)

This is one of the encoding schemes specially designed for Indian languages including Tamil. It was unified with Unicode.

Unicode:

Unicode is an encoding system, designed to handle various world languages, including Tamil. Its first version 1.0.0 was introduced in October 1991. When Unicode was introduced it could handle nearly 23 languages including Tamil. Among the various encoding scheme, Unicode is the best suitable to handle Tamil.

18.11 Tamil Operating System

An operating system is needed to access electronic systems such as computer and smart phone. Microsoft Windows is very popular operating system for personal computers. Linux is another popular open source operating system. Operating systems are used to access a computer easily. An operating system should be easy to work and its environment should be in an understandable form. Thus, all operating systems used in computers and smart phones are offered in Tamil environment.

Windows Tamil Environment interface should be downloaded and installed from the internet. It displays all window elements such as Taskbar, desktop elements, names of icons, commands in Tamil.

18.12 Organisation and projects to develop Tamil

Tamil Virtual Academy:

With the objectives of spreading Tamil to the entire world through internet, Tamil Virtual University was established on 17th February 2001 by the Govt. of Tamilnadu. Now, this organisation functions with the name of "Tamil Virtual Academy". It offers different courses in Tamil language, Culture, heritage etc., from kindergarten to under graduation level.

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